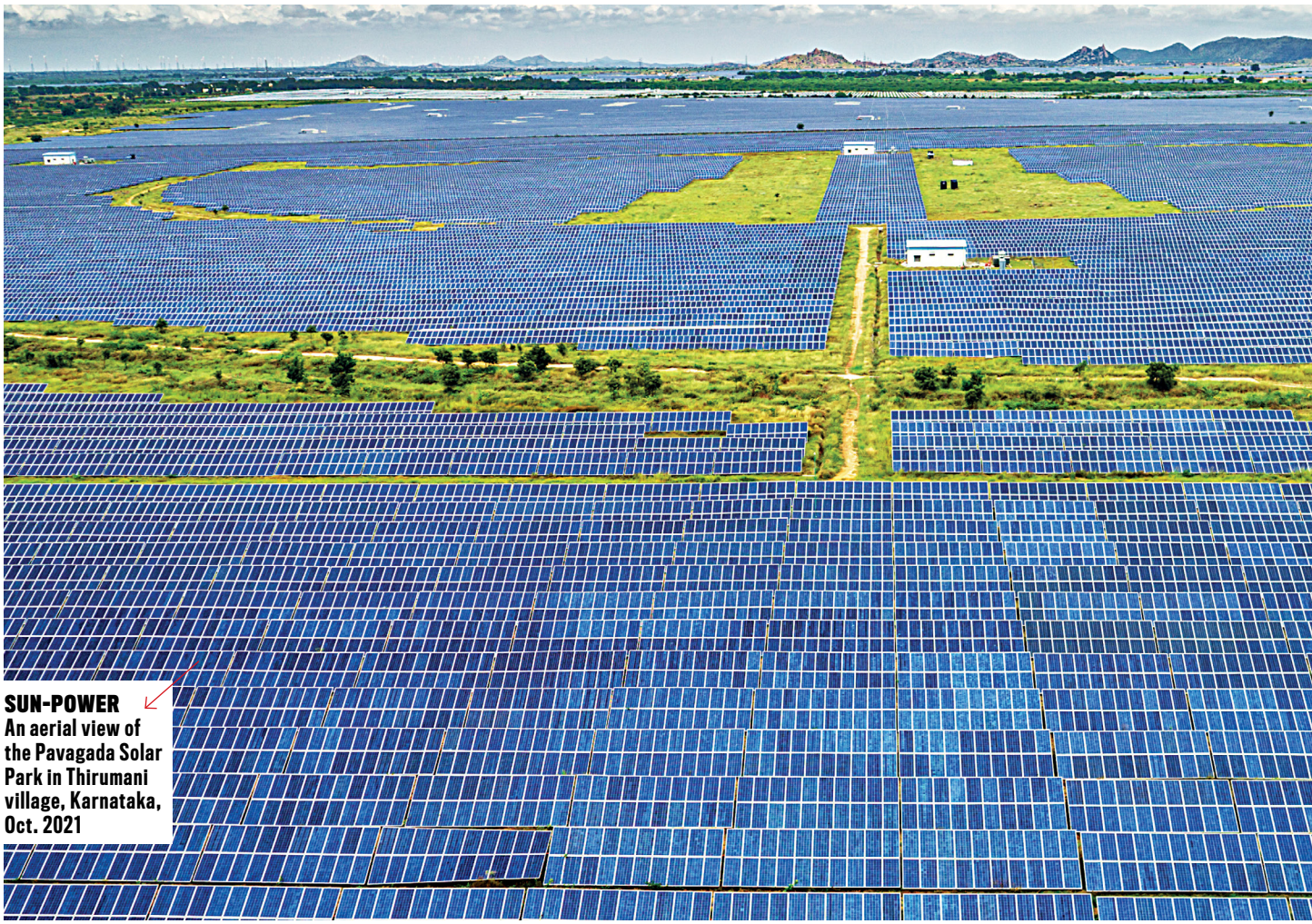


**SUN-POWER** An aerial view of the Pavagada Solar Park in Thirumani village, Karnataka, Oct. 2021

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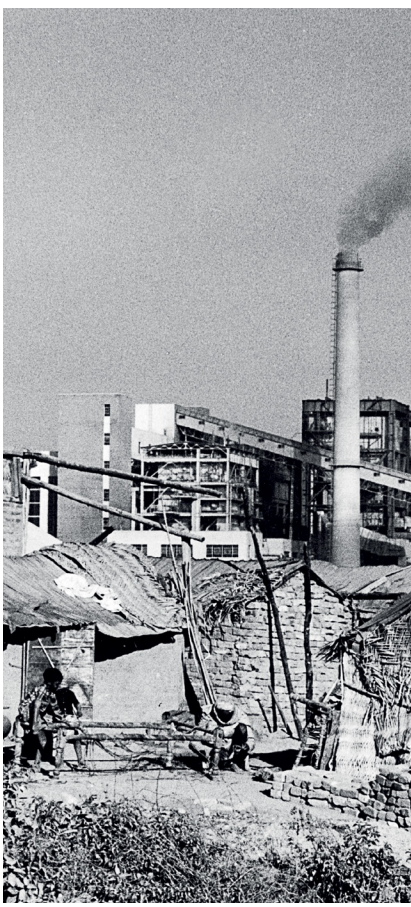
# POWER SURGE

**Though our power-generating capacity** has made a quantum leap, so has demand, causing a supply lag

*By* ***M.G. Arun***

*The Indian power sector* has come a long way since Independence when access to electricity was restricted to a few urban areas with almost no supply in rural areas. The country has taken big strides since then—both in the installed electricity-generating capacity as well as transmission & distribution (T&D). From a meagre 1,362 MW in 1947, the total power-generating capacity has increased to 403,761 MW at the end of June 2022.

Meanwhile, per capita electricity consumption has increased from just 16.3 kWh in 1947 to 805 kWh in 2021-22. However, due to the rise in consumption, the electric-



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